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# **Guidelines to open source software (according to Article 9 EMOTA)**

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This repository contains **evolving drafts** of guidelines and tools to support the Federal Administration in publishing open source code. The **official and binding versions** are available in all official languages on the [Swiss Federal Chancellery website](#).

Every document in this repository carries all five languages — English, German, French, Italian and Romansh — in a single AsciiDoc file. The German, French, Italian and Romansh texts are **unreviewed translations**; see [TRANSLATING.adoc](#) before editing them.

For a complete list of documents, see: [Tools for Publishing Open Source Software](#)

## 1. Legal obligations and responsibility

As outlined in [Article 9 EMOTA](#), the Federal Administration is **principally obligated to publish its software as open source**. Each federal authority holds independent responsibility for ensuring compliance, including making the source code publicly available.

## 2. Contributing

Contributions from the open source community and other stakeholders to these guidelines are highly valued. Have a suggestion for improvement? You can:

1. Fork the repository
2. Create your feature branch (`git checkout -b feature/AmazingFeature`)
3. Commit your changes (`git commit -m 'Add some AmazingFeature'`)
4. Push to the branch (`git push origin feature/AmazingFeature`)
5. Open a pull request

Alternatively, you can simply open an issue.

To build and check the sources on your own machine, see [DEVENV-SETUP.adoc](#).

**NOTE** You can also write in **German, French, or Italian** and refer to the [official language documents](#) where relevant.

## 3. Changes

When **major changes** are proposed, they undergo the Federal Chancellery's standard review process and, upon approval, are translated and published on the [Swiss Federal Chancellery website](#). The respective documents are then assigned a new version number. Major changes between versions can be followed using the [release](#) notes.

**Minor changes** are incorporated regularly into the official PDF publications on the [Swiss Federal Chancellery website](#).

## 4. License

These guidelines are licensed under the **CC0 1.0 Universal license**. For details, see the `LICENSE` file.

## 5. Contact

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